

Word family: **transform** / **transforms** / **transformed** / **transforming** / **transformation** / **transformative** / **transformer**

Base word: transform

Part of speech: mainly **verb**

Related forms:

* **transform** (v.) — 改變；徹底改造；轉化

* **transformed** (adj./participle) — 改變了的；徹底改造的

* **transformation** (n.) — 轉變；轉型；徹底改變

* **transformative** (adj.) — 帶來重大改變的；具轉化作用的

* **transformer** (n.) — 變壓器；轉換裝置

* **digital transformation** — 數碼轉型

* **business transformation** — 業務轉型

* **transform A into B** — 把 A 變成 B

Meaning in this passage

> It was not a dramatic **transformation** overnight, but little by little, things began to fall into place.

The passage uses the noun **transformation**, from **transform**.

Here, **transformation** means:

a major change in the speaker's habits, behaviour, and way of managing life — 巨大轉變；徹底改變

The speaker did not suddenly become perfectly organised. The change happened gradually.

中文翻譯：

這並不是一夜之間出現的戲劇性**轉變**，而是慢慢地，很多事情開始變得井然有序。

So here:

transformation = 令某人或某事由一種狀態變成明顯不同的另一種狀態

1. **transform something — 徹底改變；改造**

The central meaning.

Practice 1

> Better habits **transformed** the way I worked.

更好的習慣**徹底改變**了我的工作方式。

Practice 2

> Technology has **transformed** communication.

科技已經**徹底改變**了溝通方式。

Practice 3

> The renovation **transformed** the old building.

翻新工程把舊建築**徹底改造**了。

MCQ-ready definition:

transform = 令某人或某事出現重大改變，使其狀態、外觀、功能或性質明顯不同

2. **transform A into B** — 把 A 變成 B

A key grammar pattern.

Practice 1

> Good planning **transformed** chaos into order.

良好規劃把混亂**變成了**井然有序。

Practice 2

> The factory was **transformed** into apartments.

工廠被**改建成**住宅單位。

MCQ-ready definition:

transform A into B = 令 A 經過重大改變後成為 B

3. **be transformed by something** — 因.....而徹底改變

Practice 1

> Her life was **transformed by the experience**.

那次經歷**徹底改變了她的人生**。

Practice 2

> The area has been **transformed by new development**.

新發展令該區**面貌大變**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be transformed by X = 因 X 而產生重大而明顯的改變

4. **transform a place — 改造地方；令面貌大變**

Practice 1

> The new park **transformed the neighbourhood**.

新公園令整個社區**面貌大變**。

Practice 2

> A few simple changes **transformed the room**.

幾個簡單改動就令房間**煥然一新**。

MCQ-ready definition:

transform a place = 大幅改變某地方的外觀、用途或氣氛

5. **transform a person / someone's life — 改變某人 / 人生**

Practice 1

> The opportunity **transformed his life**.

那個機會**改變了他的人生**。

Practice 2

> University **transformed her** into a more confident person.

大學生活把她**改變成**一個更有自信的人**。**

MCQ-ready definition:

transform someone/someone's life = 令某人的性格、生活方式或人生方向出現重大變化

6. **transform the way someone does something — 改變某人的做事方式**

Very relevant to your passage.

Practice 1

> Time management **transformed the way I approached my work**.

時間管理**徹底改變**了我處理工作的方式**。**

Practice 2

> The app **transformed the way the team communicated**.

這個應用程式**徹底改變**了團隊的溝通方式**。**

MCQ-ready definition:

transform the way X = 大幅改變某件事原本的做法

7. **transformation (重大轉變) — 轉變 ; 轉型 ; 蛻變**

This is the exact family form used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> It was not a dramatic **transformation** overnight.

這並不是一夜之間出現的戲劇性**轉變**。

Practice 2

> Her **transformation** took several years.

她的**轉變**花了幾年時間。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****transformation = 由一種狀態變成明顯不同狀態的重大改變過程或結果****

8. ****dramatic transformation — 巨大 / 戲劇性的轉變****

Practice 1

> The city has undergone a ****dramatic transformation****.

這座城市經歷了****巨大轉變****。

Practice 2

> There was no ****dramatic transformation**** in my habits.

我的習慣並沒有出現****戲劇性的巨大改變****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****dramatic transformation = 非常明顯、幅度很大的轉變****

9. ****undergo a transformation — 經歷轉變****

A very common formal collocation.

Practice 1

> The company ****underwent a major transformation****.

公司****經歷了一次重大轉型****。

Practice 2

> The neighbourhood has ****undergone a remarkable transformation****.

這個社區已經****經歷了顯著轉變****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****undergo a transformation = 經歷一個重大改變的過程****

10. **personal transformation — 個人轉變；自我蛻變**

Practice 1

> The experience led to a period of **personal transformation**.

那次經歷帶來了一段**個人蛻變期**。

Practice 2

> Building better habits can support **personal transformation**.

建立更好的習慣可以促進**個人成長與轉變**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal transformation = 一個人的思維、行為、身份或生活方式出現重大改變

11. **physical transformation — 外觀 / 身體上的轉變**

Practice 1

> The building underwent a complete **physical transformation**.

建築物的外觀經歷了徹底**改造**。

Practice 2

> The renovation created a remarkable **physical transformation**.

翻新工程令地方出現顯著的**外觀轉變**。

MCQ-ready definition:

physical transformation = 外形、結構或身體狀態出現重大改變

12. **digital transformation — 數碼轉型**

A major modern business/technology use.

Practice 1

> The company is investing heavily in **digital transformation**.

公司正大力投資於**數碼轉型**。

Practice 2

> **Digital transformation** changed how customers accessed the service.

數碼轉型改變了顧客使用服務的方式。

MCQ-ready definition:

digital transformation = 機構利用數碼科技大幅改變營運、服務和工作方式的過程

13. **business / organizational transformation — 業務 / 組織轉型**

Practice 1

> The company began a major **business transformation**.

公司開始進行重大**業務轉型**。

Practice 2

> The merger triggered an **organizational transformation**.

合併引發了**組織轉型**。

MCQ-ready definition:

business/organizational transformation = 機構在結構、策略、流程或營運模式上作出重大改變

14. **transformative (帶來重大改變的) — 具轉化作用的；改變深遠的**

Practice 1

> The experience was **transformative**.

那次經歷帶來了**深遠的改變**。

Practice 2

> Education can have a **transformative effect** on people's lives.

教育可以對人生產生**改變深遠的作用**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****transformative = 能夠帶來重大、深遠改變的****

15. ****transformative experience — 改變人生 / 帶來深遠改變的經歷****

Practice 1

> Living abroad was a ****transformative experience**** for her.

在外國生活對她來說是一段****改變深遠的經歷****。

Practice 2

> The course proved to be ****transformative****.

這個課程最終對她產生了****深刻的改變****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****transformative experience = 令某人的觀念、人生方向或行為出現深刻改變的經歷****

16. ****transformative effect / impact — 轉化作用；深遠影響****

Practice 1

> Technology has had a ****transformative impact**** on education.

科技對教育產生了****深遠的轉化影響****。

Practice 2

> The new system had a ****transformative effect**** on productivity.

新制度對生產力產生了****重大轉變作用****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****transformative effect = 足以大幅改變原有狀態或方式的影響****

17. ****transformed (煥然一新的；徹底改變的) — 徹底改變了的****

Practice 1

> The **transformed building** is now a library.

那座**經過徹底改造的建築**現在是一間圖書館。

Practice 2

> She returned as a **transformed person**.

她回來時已經像**變了一個人**。

MCQ-ready definition:

transformed = 已經經歷重大改變，與以前明顯不同的

18. **transformer (電力：變壓器) — 變壓器**

A genuinely distinct technical family sense.

Practice 1

> The electricity passes through a **transformer**.

電力會經過一個**變壓器**。

Practice 2

> The **transformer** reduces the voltage.

變壓器會降低電壓。

MCQ-ready definition:

transformer = 改變交流電壓水平的電氣裝置

19. **transformer (轉換裝置) — 轉換器；變換裝置**

More broadly in technical contexts.

Practice 1

> The device uses a small **transformer**.

這個裝置使用一個小型**變換器**。

Practice 2

> The power supply contains a **transformer**.

電源供應器內含一個**變壓器**。

MCQ-ready definition:

transformer = 用來把某種電氣輸入轉換成另一種形式或電壓的裝置

Important distinction 1: **transform vs change**

change

very broad; can be small or large.

transform

usually suggests a **major and noticeable change**.

> I changed my schedule.

> 我改了時間表。

> Better habits transformed my life.

> 更好的習慣**徹底改變了我的人生**。

So:

every transformation is a change, but not every change is a transformation

Important distinction 2: **transform vs improve**

improve

become better.

transform

become very different.

A transformation can be positive or negative.

> The new routine improved my productivity.

> 新習慣提升了效率。

> The new routine transformed the way I lived.

> 新習慣徹底改變了我的生活方式。

Important distinction 3: **transform** vs **develop**

develop

grow or change gradually over time.

transform

emphasizes the substantial difference between before and after.

Something may **develop** gradually and eventually be **transformed**.

Important distinction 4: **transform** vs **reform**

transform

change form, character, function, or condition substantially.

reform

improve a system or institution by correcting problems.

> transform a business

> 令企業徹底轉型

> reform an education system

> 改革教育制度

Important distinction 5: **transform** vs **convert**

convert

change something into another type, use, system, or form.

transform

broader and often more dramatic.

> convert a file to PDF

> 把檔案轉成 PDF

> transform an old factory into a cultural centre

> 把舊工廠徹底改造成文化中心

Important distinction 6: **transform A into B**

The usual pattern is:

> **transform A into B**

not:

> *transform A to B* ⚠

For ordinary learner English, **into** is the key preposition when describing the resulting state.

Important distinction 7: **transformation vs transition**

transformation

the thing becomes significantly different.

transition

movement from one state/stage to another, emphasizing the process between them.

> transformation of the company

> 公司的重大轉型

> transition from university to work

> 由大學過渡至職場

Important distinction 8: **transformation vs improvement**

improvement

something becomes better.

transformation

something becomes substantially different.

Your passage says:

> not a dramatic transformation overnight

because the speaker did **not suddenly become a completely different person**.

Important distinction 9: **dramatic transformation**

Here **dramatic** means:

very large and noticeable

not necessarily:

像戲劇一樣

So:

> dramatic transformation = 巨大而明顯的轉變

Important distinction 10: **transformative vs transformed**

transformative

causes transformation.

> a transformative experience

> 一段帶來重大改變的經歷

transformed

has already been transformed.

> a transformed neighbourhood

> 一個面貌大變的社區

Cause vs result.

Important distinction 11: **transformative vs transformational**

Both exist.

transformative

very common for something that produces profound change.

transformational

also means producing major change, especially in organizational, leadership, and technical contexts.

For general learners, **transformative** is the more useful active vocabulary item.

Important distinction 12: **transformer is not a person who transforms things in ordinary English**

Although the morphology might suggest that, everyday **transformer** most strongly refers to:

變壓器

For a person who changes an organization or field, English would usually use a more specific noun rather than simply *a transformer*.

Family-extension note

The **transform** family has one strong semantic core:

cause something to become substantially different from what it was before

It branches into:

1. **general major change**

* transform a situation

* transform a person's life

2. **change from one form to another**

* transform A into B

3. **places and physical appearance**

* transform a building

* transformed neighbourhood

4. **personal change**

* personal transformation

* transformative experience

5. **institutional change**

* digital transformation

* business transformation

6. **major-change adjective**

* transformative

7. **technical equipment**

* transformer

For your passage, the exact family sense is:

transformation = a major change in the speaker's habits and way of living

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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transform	徹底改變；改造	major change	
transform A into B	把 A 變成 B	new state/form	
be transformed by X	因 X 而徹底改變	cause of change	
transform a place	改造地方	physical change	
transform someone's life	改變某人的人生	life change	
transform the way X	改變做事方式	method change	
transformation	轉變；轉型；蛻變	process/result	
dramatic transformation	巨大轉變	highly noticeable	

undergo a transformation	經歷轉變	experience change	
personal transformation	個人蛻變	person	
physical transformation	外觀 / 身體轉變	physical form	
digital transformation	數碼轉型	technology/business	
business transformation	業務轉型	organization	
transformative	帶來重大改變的	causes profound change	
transformative experience	改變深遠的經歷	personal effect	
transformative impact	深遠的轉化影響	major effect	
transformed	徹底改變了的	result state	
transformer	變壓器	electrical device	

For your original sentence

> It was not a dramatic **transformation** overnight, but little by little, things began to fall into place.

Here:

transformation = 從原本經常拖到最後一刻、混亂而有壓力的生活方式，轉變成更有組織、更穩定的做事方式

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 這並不是一夜之間出現的戲劇性**轉變**，但慢慢地，很多事情真的開始變得井然有序。

The cleanest contrast is:

> **change** = 改變，幅度可大可小

> **improvement** = 變得更好

> **transformation** = **前後差異很大，整體狀態出現重大轉變**

And the phrase **not a dramatic transformation overnight** deliberately stresses that the speaker's improvement was **gradual rather than sudden and complete**.